Here's the Orphanage that Mr. Niles Gave to Kansas City Kids
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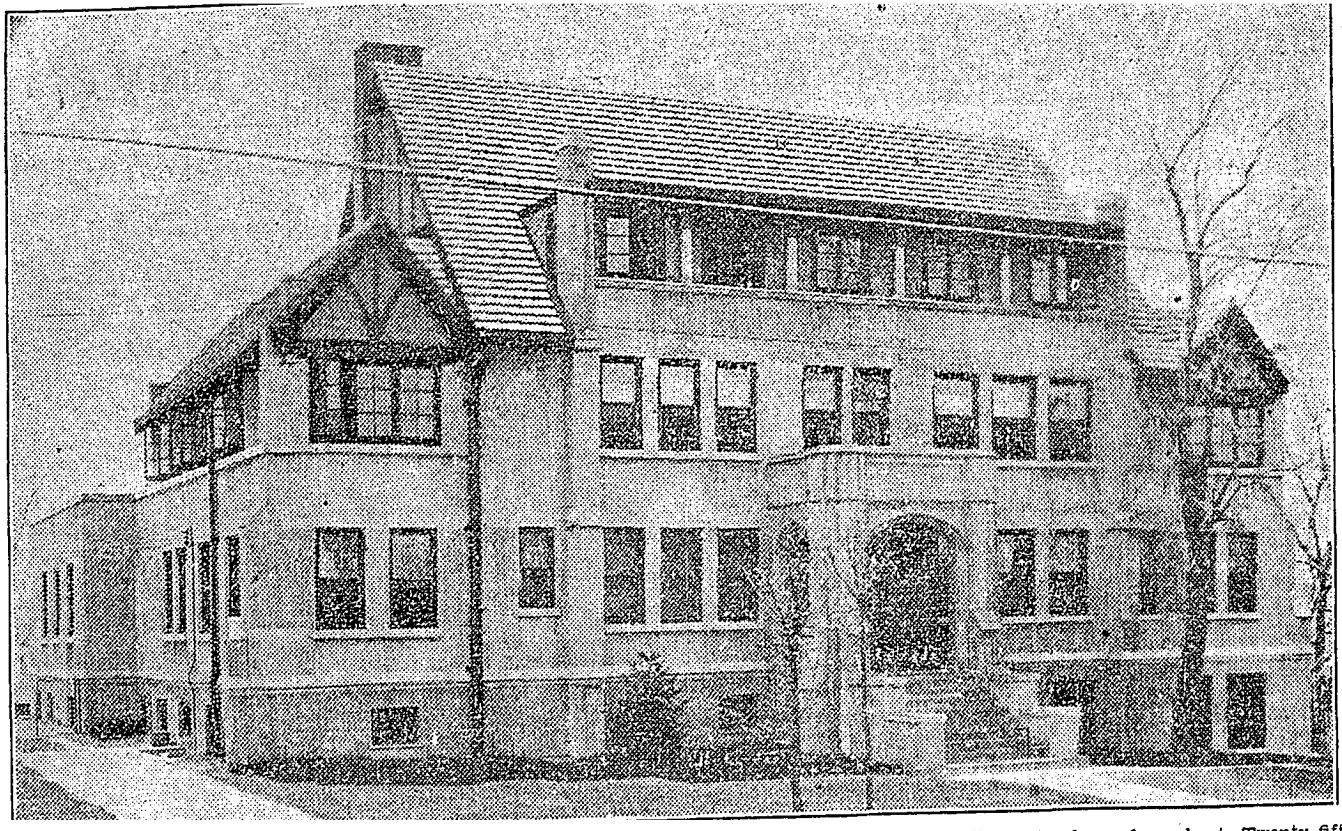

Kansas City's Negroes were hard hit when Mr. Niles died. When the housing situation became acute and certain white people objected to Negroes' getting better homes and bombings followed, it was this same Frank C. Niles who held a meeting in his office over which he presided. A solution was worked out, the bombings ceased and Mr. Niles rose to his heights by building cottages and using his influence to line up other white people to his way of thinking—that Kansas City's Negroes were entitled to a decent place to live.

And therefore the death of Mr. Niles was more than a mere passing of a fine citizen. The Negroes had lost a friend. The $125,000 given for various charities might be multiplied by other sums given without publicity.

Sunday, July 10, ten thousand people attended the Memorial exercises in honor of Mr. Niles at the Paradeway. Here such civic leaders as the Rev. C. A. Williams, representing the clergy; C. A. Franklin, editor of the Call, and close personal friend of Mr. Niles; C. H. Calloway, attorney; the Rev. D. A. Holmes, Dr. J. E. Perry, Miss Elsie Mountain of the Y.W.C.A., and Miss Alice Grady, matron of the Niles Orphans' Home, spoke five minutes each on his life and works.

Aiding in the fitting memorial were the Elks, Odd Fellows, Knights of Pythias, all branches of the Masons, the Veterans of Foreign Wars, the American Legion, the United Brothers of Friendship and the American Woodmen, all of whom formed at Twenty-fifth and Vine Streets and marched to the Paradeway. The Legion Drum and Bugle Corps, the American Federation of Music, Local 627, and the Pythian Band furnished the music.

Sitting in the shade of the trees on the Paseo side of the Paradeway was the widow, Mrs. Emma D. Niles, too overcome with emotion over the tributes paid her departed husband to come to the speakers' stand.

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